

Geography of Nepal

The types and characteristics of its topographical features, rivers, lakes, mineral resources, and political divisions (federal, provincial, and local levels).

Political Divisions:

- During the Licchavi period, Nepal was divided into 13 units.
- After the unification by Prithvi Narayan Shah, Nepal was divided into 12 administrative regions.
- During Bhimsen Thapa's time, Nepal was divided into 39 districts.
- Under the rule of Jung Bahadur Rana, Nepal was divided into 69 administrative units.
- In 1952 (B.S. 1952), during the rule of Prime Minister Bir Shumsher, Nepal was divided into 35 districts (23 in the hills and 12 in the Terai).
- On Baisakh 1, 2018 B.S., during the reign of King Mahendra, Nepal was divided into 14 zones and 75 districts.
- On Ashad 13, 2029 B.S., during the reign of King Birendra Bir Bikram Shah, Nepal was divided into 4 development regions.
- On Ashwin 26, 2037 B.S., Nepal was further divided into 5 development regions.
- On Ashoj 3, 2072 B.S., Nepal was restructured into 7 provinces and 77 districts, with the new system implemented from Bhadra 5, 2074 B.S.
- Nepal is a landlocked country located in the northern hemisphere of the Asia continent.

Nepal is 1,127 kilometers away from the sea and 700 miles from the Bay of Bengal.

The total area of Nepal is 147,181 square kilometers (56,827 square miles), according to the political and administrative map published by the Nepalese government on Jestha 7, 2077, which includes Limpiyadhura, making the total area of Nepal 147,516 square kilometers.

Greater Nepal's total area used to be 267,575 square kilometers.

Before the Sugauli Treaty, Nepal's area was 204,917 square kilometers. The Sugauli Treaty was signed on March 3, 1816.

Nepal's easternmost point is Taplejung (Lelep), its westernmost point is Dodhara of Kanchanpur, the northernmost point is Changla Bhanjyang in Humla, and the southernmost point is Lodawari in Jhapa.

Nepal occupies 0.03 percent of the world's total land area, 0.3 percent of Asia, and 2.82 percent of South Asia.

Nepal lies between 26 degrees 22 minutes and 30 degrees 27 minutes north latitude, and between 80 degrees 4 minutes and 88 degrees 12 minutes east longitude.

Nepal's official time is based on the 86 degrees 15 minutes east longitude, which passes through Gaurishankar Himal. This has been in effect since Baisakh 1, 2042 B.S. Nepal's time is 5 hours and 45 minutes ahead of Greenwich Mean Time.

Nepal's east-west length is 885 kilometers, while its average north-south width is 193 kilometers (maximum 241 kilometers and minimum 145 kilometers).

Nepal has a total international boundary of 2,926 kilometers, of which 1,690 kilometers is shared with India and 1,237 kilometers with China.

Nepal has 25 districts bordering only India, 13 districts bordering only China, and 2 districts bordering both China and India (Darchula and Taplejung).

There are 4 provinces that border both China and India: Province No. 1, Bagmati, Gandaki, and Sudurpaschim.

Province 1 (Karnali) borders only China, while two provinces, Madhesh and Lumbini, border only India.

In terms of area, Nepal is the 93rd largest country in the world, 27th largest in Asia, and 5th largest in South Asia. In terms of population, Nepal ranks 49th globally.

Geographical Division

Region	Area (%)	Population (Census 2078) (%)	Local Levels
Himal	21%	6.09%	163
Hill	62%	40.25%	314
Terai	17%	53.66%	276

According to the Local Governance Act, 2074, which was enacted on Ashoj 29, 2074 B.S., the classification of districts is as follows:

- Himalayan Districts: 21

- Hilly Districts: 28
- Inner Terai Districts: 7
- Terai Districts: 18
- Kathmandu Valley Districts: 3

• **General Knowledge on Provincial Structure**

S. No	Province Name	Capital	Province Chief	Chief Minister	Number of Districts	Number of Local Levels	Area (sq. km, %)	Population (%)	Largest and Smallest Districts	Province Naming Date
1	Koshi	Biratnagar	Parshuram Khapung	Hikmat Kumar Karki	14	137	25,905 (17.60 %)	17.01%	Taplejung & Tehrathum	2076.1.23
2	Madhesh	Janakpur	Sumitra Subedi	Satish Kumar Singh	8	136	9,661 (6.57 %)	20.99%	Saptari & Mahottari	2078.10.03
3	Bagmati	Hetauda	Yadav Chandra Sharma	Bahadur Singh Lama (Tamang)	13	119	20,300 (13.79 %)	20.99%	Sindhupalchok & Bhaktapur	2076.9.27
4	Gandaki	Pokhara	Dilliraj Bhatt	Surendra Raj Pandey	11	85	21,733 (14.61 %)	8.46%	Gorkha & Parbat	2075.3.22
5	Lumbini	Deukhuri Valley	Krishna Bahadur Gharti Magar	Chet Narayan Acharya	12	109	22,288 (15.14 %)	17.56%	Dang & Western Nawalparasi	2077.6.20
6	Karnali	Birendranagar, Surkhet	Tilak Pariyar	Yamla Kadel	10	79	27,984 (19.01 %)	5.79%	Dolpa & Rukum West	2074.11.12
7	Sudurpashchim	Godawari, Kailali	Nazir Miyan	Kamal Bahadur Shah	9	88	19,539 (13.28 %)	9.24%	Bajhang & Baitadi	2075.6.12

• **Geographic Location and Boundaries of Provinces**

Province Name	Latitude	Longitude	East Bound	West Bound	North Bound	South Bound
Koshi	26°03' N to 28°02' N	86°01' E to 88°03' E	West Bengal, India	Madhesh & Bagmati Provinces	Autonomous Region of Tibet, China	Bihar State, India

Madhesh	26°03' N to 27°07' N	84°01' E to 87°01' E	Koshi Province	Bagmati Province	Koshi & Bagmati Provinces	India (South)
Bagmati	26°55' N to 28°23' N	83°55' E to 86°34' E	Koshi Province	Gandaki Province	Autonomous Region of Tibet, China	Madhesh Province
Gandaki	27°20' N to 29°20' N	82°52' E to 85°12' E	Bagmati Province	Karnali Province	Autonomous Region of Tibet, China	Lumbini Province, Bihar, India
Lumbini	27°37' N to 28°50' N	80°58' E to 84°00' E	Gandaki Province	Karnali Province	Karnali & Gandaki Provinces	India
Karnali	28°10' N to 30°26' N	80°58' E to 83°54' E	Gandaki & Lumbini	China (Autonomous Region of Tibet)	Karnali Province	Sudurpaschim Province, China
Sudurpaschim	28°22' N to 30°09' N	80°03' E to 81°25' E	Karnali & Lumbini	India	Karnali & Autonomous Region of Tibet, China	India

• **Population Statistics of Provinces**

Province	Population (%)	Municipality (%)	Rural Municipality (%)	Gender Ratio	Population Density (per sq. km)	Household Size (Persons)	Periodic Population Change (%)	Literacy Rate (%)
Koshi	17.01%	62.4	37.6	95.02	192	4.16	9.40	79.7
Madhesh	20.97%	73	27	100.55	636	5.29	13.15	63.5
Bagmati	20.97%	77.3	22.7	99.36	301	3.89	10.62	82.1
Gandaki	8.46%	65.8	34.2	90.37	115	3.72	2.62	81.7
Lumbini	17.56%	55.2	47.8	92.01	230	4.49	13.84	78.1
Karnali	5.79%	52.1	47.9	95.27	60	4.61	7.51	76.1
Sudurpaschim	9.24%	62.4	37.6	89.51	138	4.67	5.57	76.2

The provinces with the highest population in order are Bagmati, Madhesh, Lumbini, Koshi, Sudurpaschim, Gandaki, and Karnali. (3251746)

Order of Provinces Based on Area and Population:

Provinces Ranked by Area (Largest to Smallest):

Karnali Province (27,984 sq. km)
Koshi Province (25,905 sq. km)
Lumbini Province (22,288 sq. km)
Gandaki Province (21,733 sq. km)
Bagmati Province (20,300 sq. km)
Sudurpaschim Province (19,539 sq. km)
Madhesh Province (9,661 sq. km)

Provinces Ranked by Population (Highest to Lowest):

Bagmati Province (6,116,855 people)
Madhesh Province (6,114,600 people)
Lumbini Province (5,122,078 people)
Koshi Province (4,961,412 people)
Sudurpaschim Province (2,694,783 people)
Gandaki Province (2,466,427 people)
Karnali Province (1,688,412 people)

Political Division of Nepal (Federal, Provincial, and Local Levels)

Federal

The basic structure of the Federal Democratic Republic of Nepal consists of three levels: federal, provincial, and local. The highest level of the federal structure is defined as the "federal level," also known as the federal

government. The constitution of Nepal, in Schedule 5, outlines the powers and rights of the federal level, which are to be exercised in accordance with the constitution and federal laws. Similarly, Schedule 7 includes a list of shared powers, and Schedule 9 defines shared rights between the federal, provincial, and local levels. Additionally, the federal government has the authority to exercise residual powers.

Provincial

Nepal's federal units are divided according to the constitution, with seven provinces delineated. Each province has its own territorial boundaries and structure. Here's a brief overview of each province:

Koshi Province

This province borders India's West Bengal and Sikkim to the east, Bihar to the south, Tibet (China) to the north, and Provinces No. 2 and 3 to the west. Province No. 1 includes 14 districts: Taplejung, Panchthar, Ilam, Sankhuwasabha, Terhathum, Dhankuta, Bhojpur, Khotang, Solukhumbu, Okhaldhunga, Udayapur, Jhapa, Morang, and Sunsari. The total area of this province is 25,905 sq. km (17.605% of Nepal's total area), with Taplejung being the largest district (3,646 sq. km) and Terhathum the smallest (679 sq. km). The capital is Biratnagar, and the total population is 4,961,411 (as per Central Bureau of Statistics). The province is ethnically and linguistically diverse, with major ethnic groups including Brahmins, Chhetris, Rai, Limbu, Tharu, Lepcha, Tamang, Gurung, Meche, and Kocha. Languages spoken include Nepali, Maithili, Kiranti, Tamang, Limbu, Gurung, Lepcha, Magar, and Tharu.

Madhesh Province

This province is bordered by Province No. 1 to the east, India to the south, and Province No. 1 and Bagmati Province to the north and west. Madhesh includes 8 districts: Saptari, Siraha, Dhanusha, Mahottari, Sarlahi, Rautahat, Bara, and Parsa. The total area is 9,661 sq. km (6.575% of Nepal's total area), with Saptari being the largest district (1,363 sq. km) and Mahottari the smallest (1,002 sq. km). The capital is Janakpur, and the population is 6,114,600. Ethnic and linguistic diversity is prominent, with Yadav, Gupta, Das, Tharu, Rajbanshi, and Muslims being the major ethnic groups. Maithili, Bajjika, Awadhi, Urdu, Hindi, Tharu, and Nepali are the main languages spoken.

Bagmati Province

Bagmati Province is bordered by Province No. 1 to the east, Gandaki Province to the west, China to the north, and Province No. 2 and India to the south. It includes 13 districts: Dolakha, Ramechhap, Sindhuli, Kavrepalanchok, Sindhupalchok, Rasuwa, Nuwakot, Dhading, Chitwan, Makwanpur, Bhaktapur, Lalitpur, and Kathmandu. The total area is 20,300 sq. km (13.795% of Nepal's total area), with Sindhupalchok being the largest district (2,542 sq. km) and Bhaktapur the smallest (119 sq. km). The capital is Hetauda, and the population is 6,116,855. Major ethnic groups include Tamang, Brahmin, Chhetri, and Newar, and the primary languages are Nepali, Newari, and Tamang.

Gandaki Province

This province borders Bagmati Province to the east, Karnali Province and Province No. 5 to the west, China to the north, and Province No. 5 and India's Bihar state to the south. Gandaki Province comprises 11 districts: Gorkha, Lamjung, Tanahun, Kaski, Manang, Mustang, Parbat, Syangja, Myagdi, Baglung, and Nawalparasi (East of Bardaghat Susta). The total area is 21,733 sq. km (14.615% of Nepal's total area), with Gorkha being the largest district (3,610 sq. km) and Parbat the smallest (494 sq. km). The capital is Pokhara, and the population is 2,466,427. Ethnic diversity includes Brahmins, Chhetris, Gurungs, and Magars, with Nepali, Gurung, and Magar languages spoken.

Lumbini Province

Lumbini is bordered by Gandaki Province to the east, Karnali and Sudurpashchim Provinces to the west, China to the north, and India to the south. It comprises 12 districts: Nawalparasi (West of Bardaghat Susta), Rupandehi, Kapilvastu, Palpa, Arghakhanchi, Gulmi, Eastern Rukum, Rolpa, Pyuthan, Dang, Banke, and Bardiya. The total area is 22,288 sq. km (15.145% of Nepal's total area), with Dang being the largest district (2,955 sq. km) and Nawalparasi (West of Bardaghat Susta) the smallest (634.88 sq. km). The capital is

Deukhuri Valley, Dang, and the population is 5,122,078. The province is home to Brahmins, Chhetris, Magars, Tharus, Tamangs, Muslims, and other groups, with Nepali, Tharu, Awadhi, Bhojpuri, Urdu, and Magar as the major languages.

Karnali Province

Karnali borders Gandaki and Lumbini Provinces to the east, Sudurpashchim Province and China to the west and north, and Provinces No. 5 and Sudurpashchim to the south. It includes 10 districts: Western Rukum, Salyan, Dolpa, Jumla, Mugu, Humla, Kalikot, Jajarkot, Dailekh, and Surkhet. The total area is 27,984 sq. km (19.015% of Nepal's total area), with Dolpa being the largest district (7,889 sq. km) and Western Rukum the smallest (1,213.49 sq. km). The capital is Birendranagar, Surkhet, and the population is 1,688,412. Major ethnic groups are Brahmin, Thakuri, Chhetri, Sherpa, Gurung, and Magar, with Nepali, Gurung, and Magar as the primary languages spoken.

Sudurpashchim Province

This province is bordered by Karnali Province and Province No. 5 to the east, India to the west and south, and China to the north. Sudurpashchim includes 9 districts: Bajura, Bajhang, Doti, Achham, Darchula, Baitadi, Dadeldhura, Kanchanpur, and Kailali. The total area is 19,539 sq. km (13.285% of Nepal's total area), with Bajhang being the largest district (3,422 sq. km) and Baitadi the smallest (1,519 sq. km). The capital is Godawari, Kailali, and the population is 2,694,783. Major ethnic groups are Brahmins, Chhetris, Thakuris, and Tharus, with Doteli, Khas, and Tharu as the main languages spoken.

Details of District Classification According to the Local Government Operations Act, 2074

Classified Area	Himalayan Districts	Hilly Districts	Terai Districts	Inner Madhesh Districts	Kathmandu Valley Districts
District Count	21	28	18	7	3
Largest and Smallest District by Area	Largest: Dolpa	Largest: Jajarkot	Largest: Kailali	Largest: Dang	Largest: Kathmandu
	Smallest: Rasuwa	Smallest: Parbat	Smallest: Parsa	Smallest: Nawalpur	Smallest: Bhaktapur
	1. Taplejung	1. Tehrathum	1. Morang	1. Udaypur	1. Kathmadu
	2. Sankhuwasabha	2. Panchthar	2. Jhapa	2. Sindhuli	2. Bhaktapur
	3. Solukhumbu	3. Ilam	3. Sunsari	3. Makawanpur	3. Lalitpur
	4. Dolpa	4. Okhaldhunga	4. Dhanusa	4. Chitwan	
	5. Gorakha	5. Dhankuta	5. Siraha	5. Nawalparasi	
	6. Sindhupalchok	6. Bhojpur	6. Saptari	6. Dang	
	7. Dolakha	7. Khotang	7. Mahottari	7. Surkhet	
	8. Rasuwa	8. Nuwakot	8. Sarlahi		
	9. Manang	9. Kabhrepalanchok	9. Rauthat		
	10. Mustang	10. Lamjung	10. Bara		
	11. Jumla	11. Tamahun	11. Nawalparasi		
	12. Mugu	12. Kaski	12. Parsa		
	13. Humla	13. Parbat	13. Rupandehi		
	14. Kalikot	14. Syangja	14. Kapilwastu		
	15. Bajura	15. Baglung	15. Banke		
	16. Bajhang	16. Palpa	16. Bardiya		
	17. Darchula	17. Arghakhanchi	17. Kailali		
	18. Dhading	18. Gulmi	18. Kanchanpur		
	19. Ramechhap	19. Rolpa			
	20. Myagdi	20. West Rukum			
	21. East Rukum	21. Rolpa			
		22. Salyan			

		23. Pyuthan			
		24. Jajarkot			
		25. Dailekh			
		26. Achham			
		27. Dadeldhura			
		28. Baitadi			

- The Local Government Operations Act, 2074 was authenticated by the President on 29th Ashwin, 2074.
- The Government of Nepal listed Dhading, Ramechhap, Gorkha, and East Rukum districts as Himalayan districts on 25th Bhadra, 2074.
- The Government of Nepal listed Myagdi district as a Himalayan district on 19th Falgun, 2075.

Provincial Local Level Details

Province Name	Metropolitan Cities	Sub-Metropolitan Cities	Number of Municipalities	Number of Rural Municipalities	Total Number of Local Levels	Number of House of Representatives Constituencies	Number of Provincial Assembly Election Constituencies
Koshi Province	Biratnagar	Dharan, Itahari	46	88 (Most)	137 (Highest)	28	56
Madhesh Province	Birgunj	Janakpur, Jitpur Simra, Kalaiya	73 (Most)	59	136	32	64
Bagmati Province	Lalitpur, Kathmandu, Bharatpur	Hetauda	41	74	119	33 (Highest)	66 (Highest)
Gandaki Province	Pokhara	—	26	58	85	18	36
Lumbini Province	—	Butwal, Ghorahi, Tulsipur, Nepalgunj	32	73	109	26	52
Karnali Province	—	—	25 (Lowest)	54 (Lowest)	79 (Lowest)	12 (Lowest)	24 (Lowest)
Sudurpashchim Province	—	Dhangadhi	33	54 (Lowest)	88	16	32

Information Regarding Metropolitan Cities

Criteria required to be a Metropolitan City According to the Local Government Operations Act, 2074:

- A metropolitan city must have a population of at least 500,000.
- The average annual internal revenue for the last five years must be at least 1 billion Nepali Rupees.
- At least 75% of the total road length must be paved.
- There must be at least one hospital with 100 beds, including specialized services, and a fully equipped hospital with 500 beds.
- There must be a bus park with terminals, sufficient parking facilities, subways, and footpaths.
- There should be institutions offering education up to the postgraduate level.
- There should be arrangements for an international conference hall and an international trade exhibition venue.

- There must be facilities for international-level hotels.
- There should be a children's park and a recreational area for senior citizens.
- There must be adequate recreational facilities.
- There should be a dance house and a creative gallery, among other requirements.

Metropolitan Cities of Nepal

Name	Area (sq. km)	Population	Province	District	Number of Wards	Mayor
Kathmandu	49.45	862,400	Bagmati	Kathmandu	32	Balendra Sah
Pokhara	464.24	513,504	Gandaki	Kaski	33	Dhanraj Acharya
Bharatpur	432.95	369,268	Bagmati	Chitwan	29	Renu Dahal
Lalitpur	36.12	294,098	Bagmati	Lalitpur	29	Chiribabu Maherjan
Birgunj	132.07	272,382	Madhesh	Parsa	32	Rajesh Man Singh
Biratnagar	77	234,927	Koshi	Morang	19	Nagesh Koirala

- Which is the first metropolitan city of Nepal, and when was it declared? — **Kathmandu**, declared on **December 13, 1995**.
- What are the last declared metropolitan cities, and when were they declared? — **Biratnagar** and **Birgunj**, declared on **May 1, 2017**.
- Which metropolitan city has the highest number of wards? — **Pokhara Metropolitan City** (33 wards).
- Which metropolitan city has the lowest number of wards? — **Biratnagar Metropolitan City** (19 wards).
- Which is the largest metropolitan city based on area? — **Pokhara Metropolitan City** (464.24 sq. km).
- Which is the smallest metropolitan city based on area? — **Lalitpur Metropolitan City** (36.12 sq. km).
- Who was the first mayor of Kathmandu Metropolitan City? — **Janakman Shrestha**.
- Order of metropolitan cities from largest to smallest based on area. Pokhara, Bharatpur, Birgunj, Biratnagar, Kathmandu, Lalitpur

Information on Sub-Metropolitan Cities

According to the Local Government Operation Act, 2074, the criteria required to be a sub-metropolitan city are:

- The population must be at least **200,000**.
- The average annual internal revenue over the last five years must be at least **250 million Nepali Rupees**.
- Major roads within the municipality must be paved.
- There should be at least one **100-bed hospital** facility.
- There must be facilities for higher education and technical education.
- There should be a national-level stadium, gymnasium, and covered hall.
- There must be modern slaughterhouses and organized cremation sites.
- There should be tourist-standard hotels and resorts.
- Public use places and buildings must be accessible and physically friendly for the disabled, among other criteria.

Sub-Metropolitan Cities of Nepal

Name	Area (sq. km)	Population	Province	District	Number of Wards	Mayor
Itahari	93.78	197,241	Koshi	Sunsari	20	Hem Karn Paudel
Dharan	192.32	166,531	Koshi	Sunsari	20	Hark Raj Sangpang

Janakpur	85.99	194,556	Madhesh	Dhanusha	24	Manoj Kumar Sah
Kalaiya	108.94	136,531	Madhesh	Bara	27	Binod Prasad Sah
Jitpur Simra	309.67	127,307	Madhesh	Bara	23	Rajan Paudel
Hetauda	261.59	193,573	Bagmati	Makwanpur	19	Mina Kumari Lama
Butwal	101.61	194,334	Lumbini	Rupandehi	19	Khelraj Pandey
Tulsipur	384.63	179,755	Lumbini	Dang	19	Tikaram Khadka
Ghorahi	522.21	200,530	Lumbini	Dang	19	Narulal Chaudhary
Nepalgunj	85.94	164,444	Lumbini	Banke	19	Prashant Bisht
Dhangadhi	261.75	198,792	Sudurpashchim	Kailali	19	Gopal Hamal

Ranking of Sub-Metropolitan Cities by Area (from largest to smallest)

1. Ghorahi Sub-Metropolitan City (Dang)
2. Tulsipur Sub-Metropolitan City (Dang)
3. Jitpur Simra Sub-Metropolitan City (Bara)
4. Dhangadhi Sub-Metropolitan City (Kailali)
5. Hetauda Sub-Metropolitan City (Makwanpur)
6. Dharan Sub-Metropolitan City (Sunsari)
7. Kalaiya Sub-Metropolitan City (Bara)
8. Butwal Sub-Metropolitan City (Rupandehi)
9. Itahari Sub-Metropolitan City (Sunsari)
10. Janakpur Sub-Metropolitan City (Dhanusha)
11. Nepalgunj Sub-Metropolitan City (Banke)

Ranking of Sub-Metropolitan Cities by Population (from highest to lowest)

1. Ghorahi Sub-Metropolitan City (Dang)
2. Dhangadhi Sub-Metropolitan City (Kailali)
3. Itahari Sub-Metropolitan City (Sunsari)
4. Janakpur Sub-Metropolitan City (Dhanusha)
5. Butwal Sub-Metropolitan City (Rupandehi)
6. Hetauda Sub-Metropolitan City (Makwanpur)
7. Dharan Sub-Metropolitan City (Sunsari)
8. Tulsipur Sub-Metropolitan City (Dang)
9. Nepalgunj Sub-Metropolitan City (Banke)
10. Kalaiya Sub-Metropolitan City (Bara)
11. Jitpur Simra Sub-Metropolitan City (Bara)

Information on Municipalities

Criteria for Municipalities (according to the Local Government Operation Act, 2074)

Criterion

In the Himalayan region: minimum 10,000 population; in hilly districts: minimum 40,000; in inner Madhesh: at least 50,000; in Terai districts: minimum 75,000; in Kathmandu Valley: at least 100,000 permanent residents.

Average annual internal revenue over the last five years: at least 10 million Nepali Rupees in the Himalayan region and 30 million Nepali Rupees in others.

Minimum urban facilities: roads, sidewalks, electricity, drinking water, communication, and similar.

At least 25-bed hospital facility must be available.

Provisions for higher education and technical education.

Arrangements for drinking water and sanitation must be in place.

Proper management of waste and landfill sites must be in place.

Community hall and public buildings must be present.

A market area and slaughterhouse must be available.

A sports field must be available.

A bus park with passenger resting places and public toilets must be included.

Ranking of Local Bodies Based on Area

Type of Local Body	Name	Area (sq. km)	Type of Local Body	Name	Area (sq. km)
Village Council	Namkha, Humla	2419.67	Village Council	Parwanipur, Bara	15.48
Municipality	Sitaganga, Arghakhanchi	610.43	Municipality	Bhaktapur	6.89
Sub-Metropolitan City	Ghorahi, Dang	384.36	Sub-Metropolitan City	Nepalgunj	85.94
Metropolitan City	Pokhara, Kaski	464.24	Metropolitan City	Lalitpur	36.12

Ranking of Local Bodies Based on Population

Type of Local Body	Name	Type of Local Body	Name
Village Council	Raptisonari, Banke	Village Council	Narfa, Manang
Municipality	Mechinagar, Jhapa	Municipality	Thulo Bheri, Dolpa
Sub-Metropolitan City	Ghorahi, Dang	Sub-Metropolitan City	Jitpur, Bara
Metropolitan City	Kathmandu	Metropolitan City	Biratnagar, Morang

Top 5 Villages with Highest Population Growth Rate

Village Council	Population	Growth Rate %
Kanchan Village Council, Rupandehi	42,528	2.41
Rakti Village Council, Dang	52,123	2.36
Baijnath Village Council, Banke	69,472	2.34
Buddhashanti Village Council, Jhapa	53,010	2.33
Budhiganga Village Council, Morang	51,497	2.05

Top 5 Municipalities with Highest Population Growth Rate

Municipality	Population	Growth Rate %
Kageshwori Manohara Municipality, Kathmandu	130,433	7.41
Mahalaxmi Municipality, Lalitpur	123,116	6.56
Tarakeshwar Municipality, Kathmandu	151,479	5.96
Surya Binayak Municipality, Bhaktapur	140,085	5.56
Nagarjun Municipality, Kathmandu	115,437	5.16

Top 5 Districts with Highest Negative Population Growth Rate

District	Population	Growth Rate %
Ramechhap	170,302	-1.67
Khotang	175,298	-1.56
Manang	5,658	-1.39
Bhojpur	157,923	-1.39
Tehrathum	88,731	-1.30

Top 5 Villages with Highest Negative Population Growth Rate

Village Council	Population	Growth Rate %
Chaure Deurali Village Council, Kavre	14,076	-3.76
Rishing Village Council, Tanahun	17,918	-3.52
Necha Salyan Village Council, Solukhumbu	11,381	-3.35
Manang Dsyad Village Council, Manang	1,595	-3.18
Baudikali Village Council, Nawalparasi East	11,338	-3.14

Top 5 Municipalities with Highest Negative Population Growth Rate

Municipality	Population	Growth Rate %
Sanfebagar Municipality, Achham	25,891	-2.55

Jaimini Municipality, Baglung	24,628	-2.53
Mangal Sen Municipality, Achham	26,557	-1.94
Galyang Municipality, Syangja	31,034	-1.90
Phalewas Municipality, Parbat	20,468	-1.80

Top 5 Districts with Highest and Lowest Population Density

High Population Density Districts	Density	Low Population Density Districts	Density
Kathmandu	5,169	Manang	3
Bhaktapur	3,631	Mustang	4
Lalitpur	1,433	Dolpa	5
Dhanusha	825	Humla	10
Mahottari	737		

Districts with the Lowest Population Density in the Terai

- Udayapur (166 people)
- Rukum East (35 people) - a hilly district
- Manang (3 people) - a Himalayan district

Municipalities with the Highest Population

- Kathmandu Metropolitan City – 862,400
- Pokhara Metropolitan City – 513,504
- Bhaktapur Metropolitan City – 369,268
- Lalitpur Metropolitan City – 294,098
- Birgunj Metropolitan City – 272,382

Five Municipalities with the Lowest Population

- Thulo Bherry Municipality, Dolpa – 9,861
- Tripurasundari Municipality, Dolpa – 12,233
- Madi Municipality, Sankhuwasabha – 13,278
- Laliguras Municipality, Tehrathum – 15,329
- Dharmadevi Municipality, Sankhuwasabha – 16,053

Villages with the Highest Population

- Baijnath Village Council, Banke – 69,472
- Raptisonari Village Council, Banke – 66,445
- Khajura Village Council, Banke – 62,789
- Mayadevi Village Council, Rupandehi – 56,170
- Gaidahwa Village Council, Rupandehi – 56,149

Villages with the Lowest Population

- Narphabhoomi Village Council, Manang – 396
- Chame Village Council, Manang – 1,276
- Lo-Ghekar Damorkund Village Council, Mustang – 1,292
- Lomathang Village Council, Mustang – 1,430
- Manang Dsyang Village Council, Mustang – 1,595

Districts with the Highest Absentee Population Abroad

- Kathmandu
- Kailali
- Jhapa
- Rupandehi
- Morang

Districts with the Lowest Absentee Population Abroad

- Manang
- Dolpa
- Humla
- Mugu
- Mustang

Village Council with the Highest Population

- **Baijnath Village Council (Banke)**

Village Council with the Lowest Population

- **Narphabhoomi Village Council**

Average Family Size in Nepal

- The average family size in Nepal is **4.37** people. The district with the smallest family size is **Dolakha** (3.49 people), and the district with the largest family size is **Rautahat** (5.94 people).

Additional Information Related to Local Governance

- The Local Government Operation Act consists of 15 chapters, 121 articles, and 2 schedules.
- The Local Government Operation Act, 2074, was certified by the President on **29 Asoj 2074**.

Local Bodies

- **Metropolitan Cities:** 6
- **Sub-Metropolitan Cities:** 11
- **Total Village Municipalities:** 46
- **Total Municipalities:** 276
- **Total Local Bodies:** 753
- **Total Wards:** 6,743
- **Districts Without Municipalities:** 5 (Manang, Mustang, Humla, Rasuwa, Eastern Rukum)
- **Districts Without Village Councils:** 2 (Kathmandu and Bhaktapur)
- **District with the Fewest Local Bodies:** Eastern Rukum (3)
- **Districts with 18 Local Bodies:** 3 districts – Dhanusha, Saptari, Rautahat
- **Districts with 17 Local Bodies:** 2 districts – Siraha, Morang

Districts Without Municipalities

- Districts Without Municipalities: Manang, Mustang, Rasuwa, Humla, Eastern Rukum

Equal Area Municipalities

- Equal Area Municipalities: Banepa and Dhulikhel (55 sq. km)
- Equal Area Village Councils: Champadevi and Chisukhugadhi (126.91 sq. km, Okhaldhunga)

Municipality with the Longest Name

- **Khalasa Chhintang Shahid Bhumi Village Council, Dhankuta**

Geographical Comparisons

- Nepal is **22 times smaller than India** and **65 times smaller than China**.
- The country closest to Nepal after India and China is **Bangladesh**, located **27 km** away.
- The distance between Nepal and Bhutan is **32 km**.
- Districts that share borders with the most other districts are **Sindhuli** (10) and **Makwanpur** (9).
- The longest glacier in Nepal is the **Khumbu Glacier**, measuring **32 km**, and the largest glacier is the **Langtang Glacier**, measuring **20 km**.

District Information

- The youngest districts in Nepal are **Eastern Rukum** and **Nawalpur**.
- The district with a volcanic symbol is **Dailekh**.
- The old name of **Surkhet** district is **Dobhanchaur**.
- **Janakpur** is known as the city of 52 huts and 72 ponds.
- **Bhukhuwa** is located in **Rupandehi**.
- **Baglung** is the district that matches the map of Nepal, while **Koshi Island** is referred to as Nepal's Sri Lanka. The district that matches Nepal's map is **Portugal**.
- The area of the **Kathmandu Valley** is **642 square km**, and the nearest mountain from Kathmandu is **Jugal**.
- The regions with equal area are **Koshi** and **Janakpur**, which have an area of **9,669 square km**.
- The districts with equal area are **Ramechhap** and **Tanahun** (1,564 square km), and **Bardiya** and **Doti** (2,025 square km).
- The largest local body is **Namkha Village Municipality** in **Humla**, with an area of **2,419 square km**.
- The municipality with the smallest area is **Bhaktapur Municipality**, with an area of **6.89 square km**.

- The highest inhabited place is **Dolpa's Chharkhobot** and **Tarap Village**, while the deepest gorge, created by the **Kaligandaki River**, is **Andhaglchi** in **Myadi** district.
- The metropolitan city with the most wards is **Pokhara (33)**, followed by **Kathmandu** and **Birgunj (32)**.
- The metropolitan city with the fewest wards is **Biratnagar (19)**.
- The sub-metropolitan city with the most wards is **Kalaiya (Bara) (27)**.

Local Body Programs

Program	Local Body
Buffalo maternity allowance	Bagchaur Municipality, Salyan
Cow maternity allowance	Ratnanagar Municipality, Chitwan
Pension system for farmers	Budhiganga Municipality, Bajura
Rs. 10 fruit tree planting program	Ichhakamana Village Municipality, Chitwan
Zero Home Delivery Campaign	Malika Village Municipality, Gulmi
Conversion of urine into accounting campaign	Mangal Village Municipality, Myadi
Mayor's Agriculture Program	Bardibas Municipality, Mahottari
Mayor's Employment Program	Chandnath Municipality, Jumla
Seed Bank Program	Lalitpur Municipality, Lalitpur
Labor Development Bank Employment Program	Raskot Municipality, Kalikot
Program for the poor with the municipality	Belwari Municipality, Morang
First local body to launch the "One Village One Helipad" program	Airawati Village Municipality, Pyuthan
First local body to establish an IT center	Safebagar Municipality, Achham
Local body conducting the "One Student One Walnut Tree" program	Dhualagiri Village Municipality, Myadi
Community Seed Bank establishment	Machapuchhre Village Municipality
Local body launching the "Go Home, Daughter-in-law" campaign	Bigu Village Municipality, Dolakha
Go Home, Dear Ones	Mahashila Village Municipality, Parbat
Providing buffalo maternity allowance	Jaljala Village Municipality, Parbat
Grant of Rs. 20,000 to farmers raising goats	Paiyun, Village Municipality, Parbat
"One House One Pond" program	Dhanukot Municipality, Dhanukuta
"One Ward One Lake" program	Ghorahi Sub-Metropolitan City, Dang
"One Forest One Pond" program	Butwal Sub-Metropolitan City, Rupandehi
Mayor's Agriculture Program	Badivas Municipality, Mahottari
"One Teacher One Laptop" program	Mahashila Village Municipality, Parbat
Grant for single men	Helambu Municipality, Sindhupalchok
Allowance for unmarried women and single men	Dungeshwar Village Municipality, Dailekh
Monthly Rs. 1,000 for those over 50	Melauli Municipality, Baitadi
"One School One Gadget" program	Kohalpur Municipality, Banke
Local body promoting "One Ward One Gym" plan	Tokha Municipality, Kathmandu
"One Student One House One Walnut Tree" program	Dhualagiri Village Municipality, Myadi
Beautiful Lalitpur City, City Police in Every House	Lalitpur Sub-Metropolitan City, Lalitpur
Doctor in Every House Program	Gandaki Village Municipality, Gorkha
Prohibition of alcoholic beverages, welcome guests with flowers	Ichhakamana Village Municipality, Chitwan

Marriage invitation card must mention the birth date of the bride and groom	Athbis Kot Municipality, Rukum West
Marriage age eligibility certificate required	Golanjor Village Municipality, Sindhuli
Free education for grade 11 and 12 students	Risirijhaga Village Municipality, Taplejung
"One Ward One Blacktopped Road"	Phungling Municipality, Taplejung

First Local Body Programs

Program	Local Body
First street human-free road sub-metropolitan	Butwal Sub-Metropolitan City
First municipality to ban alcohol	Rara Chhaynath Municipality, Mugu
Municipality banning <i>Panipuri</i> and <i>Chatpate</i>	Baglung Municipality, Baglung
First municipality to establish an IT center	Safebagar Municipality, Achham
Declared as the city of art by the World Art Council	Lalitpur Metropolitan City, Lalitpur
First human rights-friendly village	Tilagufa Municipality, Kalikot
First child labor-free municipality	Hetauda Sub-Metropolitan City, Makwanpur
First to start the "One Village One Helipad" program	Airawati Village Municipality, Pyuthan
First municipality to declare free from electric leakage	Kankai Municipality, Jhapa
"A moment in the fields every week"	Dhulikhel Municipality, Kavre
Local body planning "One Ward One Blacktopped Road"	Phungling Municipality, Taplejung
Nepal's first zero polythene and completely clean local body	Tilottama Municipality, Rupandehi
The first child marriage-free local body in the country	Buddha Bhumi Municipality, Jhapa
Local body conducting the "One Student One Walnut Tree" program	Dhaulagiri Village Municipality, Myadi

Names of Various Cities in Nepal

- **Selfie City** – Dhanukuta
- **Free Wi-Fi City** – Devchuli
- **Child-Friendly Local Governance City** – Sunwal
- **Green City** – Hetauda
- **Pink City** – Waling, Syangja
- **Medical City** – Chitwan
- **Bicycle City** – Dharan
- **Eco City** – Madi, Chitwan

Division of Nepal Based on Rivers

(A) Koshi Region (Province)

The area between **Kanchanjunga Himal** in the east and **Langtang Himal** (Gosainkunda) in the west is known as **Koshi Province**. The **Saptakoshi River** is formed by the confluence of the **Tamor, Arun, Likhu, Dudh Koshi, Tama Koshi, Sun Koshi**, and **Indrawati** rivers. This is the largest river in Nepal, stretching **720 km** with an average flow capacity of **1,564 cubic meters per second**. It is estimated that up to **22,000 MW** of electricity can be generated from this river. The influence area of Koshi Province is nearly **60,000 square km**. The largest tributary of the Saptakoshi River is the **Arun**, while the smallest is the **Likhu**.

(B) Gandaki Region (Province)

The area affected by the **Gandaki River** from the east **Langtang Himal** to the west **Dhaulagiri Himal** is known as **Gandaki Province**. The seven major tributaries of the Gandaki River are **Trishuli, Budhi Gandaki, Daroudi, Madi, Marsyangdi, Seti Gandaki**, and **Kali Gandaki**. It is believed that this river is named after **Gandav Rishi** and, after reaching **Chitwan district** (below Devghat), it is known as the **Narayani River**. This river flows through central Nepal, with a drainage area of about **38,000 square km**. The river is approximately **338 km** long, with an estimated power generation capacity of about **21,000 MW**. Among its tributaries, **Kali Gandaki** is the largest and **Daroudi** is the smallest. This river is the deepest in Nepal, averaging a flow of **1,713 cubic meters per second**.

(C) Karnali Region (Province)

The area influenced by the **Karnali River** between the **Dhaulagiri Himal** in the east and **Vyas Himal** in the west is known as **Karnali Province**. The seven major tributaries of the Karnali River are **Humla Karnali, Mugu Karnali, Thuli Bheri, Sani Bheri, Tila, Budhi Ganga, and Seti River**. It is also referred to as the longest river in Nepal. After reaching India, this river is also known as **Ghaghara** and sometimes **Sarayu**. This river flows over an area of about **42,000 square km**. It is approximately **507 km** long, with an estimated power generation capacity of **32,000 MW**. The average flow capacity of this river is **1,316 cubic meters per second**.

Summary for Study

River	Tributaries	Flow Capacity (cubic m/s)	Length (km)	Hydropower Capacity (MW)	Area (sq km)	Notable Features
Koshi	Tamor, Arun, Dudh Koshi, Likhu, Tama Koshi, Sun Koshi, Indrawati	1,564	720	22,000	60,000	Largest river; named after Kaushik Rishi
Gandaki	Trishuli, Budhi Gandaki, Daroudi, Marsyangdi, Madi, Seti Gandaki, Kali Gandaki	1,713	338	21,000	38,000	Deepest river; named after Gandaki Rishi
Karnali	Sani Bheri, Thuli Bheri, Mugu Karnali, Tila, Humla Karnali, Budhi Ganga, Seti River	1,316	507	32,000	42,000	Longest river in Nepal

Origin of Rivers

River	Sources	Origins	Mythical Names
Saptakoshi	Tamor, Arun, Dudh Koshi, Likhu, Tama Koshi, Sun Koshi, Indrawati	Kumbhakarna Himal, Tibet, Dudh Kund, Rolwaling Himal, Tibet, Jugal Himal	Papadhini, Mahaprabha, Hemganga
Saptagandaki	Trishuli, Budhi Gandaki, Daroudi, Marsyangdi, Madi, Seti Gandaki, Kali Gandaki	Tibet, Ganesh, Buddha Himal, Annapurna Himal, Annapurna II, Annapurna III, Lake Mustang	Dharmadhara, Yashodhara, Vishwadharma, Shitprabha, Ratnadhara, Suvarnasarita, Krishna Gandaki
Karnali	Sani Bheri, Thuli Bheri, Mugu Karnali, Tila, Humla Karnali, Budhi Ganga, Seti River	Dhaulagiri Himal, Mukut Himal, Laddakh Himal, Tibet, Jagudulla, Saipal Himal	-

Water Resources

Although Nepal is deprived of maritime facilities, it is considered the second richest country in the world in terms of water resources, after Brazil, and the richest in Asia. There are more than 6,000 rivers and streams in Nepal. The reservoir capacity of Nepal's three major rivers—Koshi, Gandaki, and Karnali—accounts for 148,000 cubic meters, which is 74% of the total water storage capacity. The total hydropower production capacity is approximately 83,000 megawatts. Rivers in Nepal can be classified into three categories based on their flow, storage, and utility:

1. **First-level rivers:** Major rivers such as Sapta Koshi, Sapta Gandaki, and Karnali originate from the melting snow of the Himalayas and flow continuously with large volumes of water. These rivers are considered useful for large hydropower and irrigation projects.
2. **Second-level rivers:** Rivers that originate from the Mahabharat range, located below the Himalayas, which flow continuously without drying up, but have higher water levels during the rainy season and

significantly lower levels in winter. Rivers like Mechi, Kanakai, Triyuga, Kamala, Bagmati, Banaganga, Tinau, Rapti, Babai, and Mohana fall under this category.

3. **Third-level rivers:** These are temporary rivers that originate from the Siwalik mountain range (Chure hills), which swell significantly during the monsoon and reduce or dry up in winter. Examples include Sirsiya, Tilabe, Jamuni, Hardinath, Dundwa, and Arjun Khola. These rivers are often used for seasonal agriculture and short-term irrigation.

Nepal's Rivers: There are over 6,000 rivers and streams in Nepal, with a total length exceeding 45,000 km. In addition to the vast storage capacity, the continuous flow of rivers from the Himalayan region gives the country a hydropower capacity of over 83,000 megawatts, and it is estimated that around 42,000 megawatts can be generated from an economic and technical perspective.

Hydropower Production Capacity and Rivers: The major three rivers of Nepal—Koshi, Gandaki, and Karnali—cover a total of 905 sites for hydropower production capacity as follows:

- **Karnali River:** 32,000 MW
- **Koshi River:** 22,000 MW
- **Gandaki River:** 21,000 MW
- **Other Rivers:** 8,000 MW

Rivers originating from the (Bhot) Himalayas:

1. Arun
2. Tama Koshi
3. Karnali
4. Trishuli
5. Sun Koshi
6. Tamor

Name Changes of Nepalese Rivers in India:

- Kanakai – Biring
- Koshi – Damodar
- Mechi – Mahananda
- Mahakali – Sharda
- Babai – Saryu
- Karnali – Ghaghara

Origin Sites of Various Rivers in Nepal

River	Origin Site
Bagmati	Bagdwar
Kali Gandaki	Mustang Region
Seti River	Annapurna Himal
Madi	Lamjung Himal
Likhu	Rolwaling Himal
Budi Gandaki	Ladakh Himal
Jhimruk	Gaumukhi
Humla Karnali	Near Tibet Manasarovar
Marsyangdi	Damodar Himal
Dudhkoshi	Mahalungur
Tamor	Kumbhakarna Himal
Budi Ganga	Jagdulla Tal
Mahakali	Api Himal
Indravati	Five Lakes of Jugal Himal
Tinau	Chure Mountain
Thulo Bheri	Kanjirova Himal
Vishnumati	Sapan Tirth
Daroudi	Buddha Himal
Mechi	Lalikhark

Major Lakes of Nepal:

Tilicho Lake

Tilicho Lake is located at an altitude of 4,919 meters above sea level, nestled in the lap of the Fokche Himal. This picturesque lake lies in the northern region of the Annapurna Himal in the Manang district of Mustang. The lake has a length of about 4 km, a width of 1.2 km, and a depth of approximately 200 meters. It is also known as Tiri-cho or Tilijo. To the north of this lake is Nilgiri and to the south is the Annapurna Himal. The lake is exceptionally beautiful due to its snow, water, and rocky surroundings.

Rara Lake

Located in the Mugu district, Rara Lake is renowned as the largest lake in Nepal. It has a length of 5.2 km, a width of 2.4 km, and a depth of 167 meters. The lake is situated at an altitude of 2,990 meters above sea level and is also referred to as Mahendra Lake.

Foksundo Lake

Foksundo Lake is located in the Dolpa district, at an altitude of approximately 3,613 meters above sea level, at the southern base of Kanjirova Himal and near the head of the main branch of the Bheri River, Jagdulla Khola. The lake appears long from north to south and wide from east to west. It measures around 4.82 km in length and 1.61 km in width. Its local name is 'Rigmo.' The lake has a unique three-cornered shape and is the second-largest lake in the country after Rara, as well as the deepest lake in Nepal. The water in this lake is extremely cold, making it devoid of any living creatures. There is also a waterfall of approximately 176 meters in the Suligad River, which serves as the lake's outlet.

Tsho Rolpa Lake

Located in the Dolkha district, this lake is situated at an altitude of 4,580 meters above sea level. It measures 3 km in length, 0.5 km in width, and has a depth of 100 meters. The lake is estimated to hold around 80 million cubic meters of water. Due to the risk of an explosion, a siphon has been installed to drain water from the lake to prevent any potential disasters.

Phewa Lake

Phewa Lake, located in Pokhara, Kaski district, has a length of 4.8 km, a width of 1.5 km, and a depth of 24 m. The reflection of the Machapuchhre mountain in the lake makes it extraordinarily beautiful, and it is also significant from a tourism perspective.

Rani Pokhari

Rani Pokhari was built by King Pratap Malla to comfort his queen, Anantpriya, who was grieving the loss of their son. This pond measures 180 meters in length, 140 meters in width, and covers an area of nearly 32 ropanis. In the northeast and northwest corners of this pond, Bhairav and Mahalaxmi are established, respectively, while in the southwest corner, a statue of the right-hand Ganesh is set up.

Taudaha

Located in Kathmandu, Taudaha is connected to Rani Pokhari. According to legend, when Manjushree cut the hill with a sword or when Lord Krishna threw his discus to drain the water from the valley, it created a need for the Nagas (serpents) to leave the area. Thus, a pond was created at Chobhar, providing a habitat for the Naga King Karkotak, which is why Taudaha is also referred to as the abode of the Karkotak Nag. It covers an area of 96 ropanis, including an 84 ropani water area. Many types of birds can be found here, making it an attractive place for studying and researching avian life.

Ghodaghodi Lake

Ghodaghodi Lake, located in Kailali district, spreads over an area of 1.5 hectares in a shape resembling a palm on the northern side of the Mahendra Highway. There are four to five mounds in the middle of this lake. The lake is named after the Ghodaghodi temple located nearby. The surrounding forest is home to many animals and rare birds like the Dhaneesh. The lake hosts various aquatic creatures, including fish, turtles, and other wildlife. Located at an altitude of 677 meters above sea level, Begnas Lake lies on the opposite side of the Pachbhaiya hill, measuring 7.5 m in depth and covering 225 hectares.

Gosainkunda

Gosainkunda, which attracts thousands of pilgrims on the day of Janai Purnima, is also recognized as a religious pilgrimage site. It is located in the Rasuwa district of the Bagmati zone, Province No. 3. This lake, filled with pure water, is situated at an altitude of approximately 4,360 meters above sea level, formed from the Sun Kund (east) and northern waterfalls. Rupa Lake lies in the northeastern part of Pokhara in Kaski district, at the foot of Pachbhaiya mountain. This lake is located at an altitude of 701 meters above sea level,

has a depth of 4.5 meters, and covers an area of 120 hectares. Fish farming has recently begun in this lake for economic benefit.

Summary of Important Lakes

Lake	District	Altitude (m)	Length (km)	Width (km)	Depth (m)
Tilicho	Manang	4,919	4	1.2	200
Foksundo	Dolpa	3,613	4.8	1.61	650
Rara	Mugu	3,200	5.2	2.4	167
Tsho Rolpa	Dolkha	4,580	3	0.5	100
Phewa Lake	Kaski	900	4.8	1.5	24

Which Lake is in Which District?

S.N.	District	Located Lakes
1	Kaski	Phewa Lake, Rupa Lake, Begnas Lake, Dipang Lake, Mairi Lake, Khaste Lake, Baduwa Lake, Syarkhu Lake, and Shantikund
2	Rasuwa	Gosainkunda, Bhairavkunda, Saraswatikunda, Surya Kunda, Parvatikunda, Ganesh Kunda, Nag Kunda, and Dudh Kunda
3	Dang	Bahra Kune Lake, Syanglang Dham, Bhoté Dham, Ringe Dham, Saptakund, Jalasinni Lake, and Kichakni Dham
4	Palpa	Satyawati Lake, Nandan Lake, and Suke Lake
5	Mugu	Rara Lake (Mahendratol), Rinmoksha Dham, Chhayanath Dham, and Papakund
6	Chitwan	Gadwa Lake, Kasra Lake, Tamor Ghaela Lake, Mujura Lake, Nandbhauju Lake, Bishahazari Lake, and Sohra Hazaar Lake
7	Myagdi	Bhale Basne Lake
8	Baglung	Rudra Lake, Jalpa Lake, and Ganoune Bhafutta Lake
9	Dolpa	Putha Dham, Jagadulla Lake, Foksundo Lake, Suke Dham, and Khali Dham
10	Gorkha	Kalchuman Lake, Kal Pokhari, Runche Lake, Nag Kunda, etc.
11	Rupandehi	Gajadi Lake
12	Parbat	Khari Barah Lake
13	Udayapur	Rautah Pokhari, Jogi Dham
14	Arghakhanchi	Thada Dham, Syalang Dham
15	Bhojpur	Kal Pokhari, Salpa Pokhari
16	Jumla	Giri Dham, Sheikh Dham, and Bisht Dham
17	Kanchanpur	Betkote Dham, Jhilmila Lake, Bonda Lake, and Rani Lake
18	Kathmandu	Rani Pokhari, Kamal Pokhari, Pani Pokhari, Nag Pokhari, Taudaha, and Katwal Dham
19	Sankhuwasabha	Sabha Pokhari, Siddha Pokhari, Matsya Pokhari, Panch Pokhari, Dudh Kunda
20	Sindhupalchok	Panch Pokhari, Baulaha Pokhari
21	Bardiya	Budaiya Lake
22	Siraha	Patter Pokhari
23	Doti	Khaptad Lake, Sun Dham
24	Bara	Kamini Dham
25	Lamjung	Deu Pokhari, Indra Pokhari, Bahra Pokhari, Nima Pokhari, Dudh Pokhari, Ilam Pokhari
26	Panchthar	Jor Pokhari, Timbu Pokhari
27	Surkhet	Bulbule Lake, Simrakhani Dham, Murali Dham, and Khaudham
28	Sindhuli	Gajuli Dham
29	Darchula	Resunga Lake
30	Parsa	Banjari Lake
31	Dolakha	Jata Pokhari, Chhorolpa Himmatala

Lakes in Nepal (Glacial Lakes)

Lake Name	District	Lake Name	District
Namja Pokhari	Taplejung	Lower Varun	Sankhuwasabha
Imja Pokhari, Lamdhi, Hungdi	Solukhumbu	Thulaji	Manang
Chhoroalpa Himmatala	Dolakha	Cholaso Lake	Manang

Major Waterfalls in Nepal

Waterfall	District	Waterfall	District
Pachhal Waterfall	Kalikot	381 m	Hyatrung Waterfall
Suligad, Khaliban, Tipla, Khadekhola Waterfall	Dolpa	Badha Waterfall	Sankhuwasabha
Tipatal	Taplejung	Namaste	Dhankuta
Bhairavkunda, Gumsathal	Sindhupalchok	Odarikhola	Udayapur
Ratamata and Pokali	Okhaldhunga	Jhahare Waterfall	Palpa
Gangajamuna	Dhading	Purandhara	Dang
Jorpani	Doti	Chamche	Lamjung
Thuli Chhara	Dailekh	Sunchhari, Jai Chhara, Laharikhola	Rolpa
Rupse Waterfall	Myagdi	Bawali Village Waterfall	Dolpa

Cities Located Along Rivers

City	District	River	City	District	River
Kathmandu	Kathmandu	Bagmati	Ghorahi	Dang	Babai
Bidur	Nuwakot	Trishuli	Syangjabazar	Syangja	Andhi Khola
Pokhara	Kaski	Seti Gandaki	Beni	Myagdi	Kaligandaki
Damauli	Tanahun	Seti/Madi	Jomsom	Mustang	Kaligandaki
Besishahar	Lamjung	Marsyangdi	Chame	Manang	Marsyangdi
Baglung	Baglung	Kaligandaki	Mahendranagar	Kanchanpur	Mahakali
Kusma	Parbat	Modi	Jumla	Jumla	Tila
Butwal	Rupandehi	Tinau	Gaighat	Udayapur	Triyuga
Dipayal	Doti	Seti	Kankadbitta	Jhapa	Mechi
Chandragadhi	Bhaktapur	Mechi	Dhunche	Rasuwa	Trishuli
Manthali	Ramachhap	Sun Koshi	Bharatpur	Chitwan	Narayani
Hetauda	Makwanpur	Rapti			

Classification of Nepal Based on Climate (Climate Zones)

Nepal's climate can be classified into five types based on geographical structure and altitude.

(a) Sub Tropical Monsoon Climate

Also known as semi-tropical and sub-tropical climate, this type of climate is found in the Terai, Bhawar, Dun, and Chure regions of Nepal at altitudes up to 1,200 meters (4,000 feet). In summer, the temperature here rises to 38 to 42 degrees Celsius, while in winter, it drops to 15 to 5 degrees Celsius. The monsoon winds coming from the Bay of Bengal in the Indian Ocean bring rainfall during the rainy season. Rainfall generally decreases from east to west and increases from north to south, resulting in higher temperatures in the western Terai compared to the eastern Terai. Notably, places like Bhairahawa, Nepalgunj, and Kailali experience significant heat. Similarly, the inner Terai regions like Dang and Surkhet also experience considerable warmth.

(b) Warm Temperate Climate

Found at altitudes of 1,200 to 2,100 meters (4,000–7,000 feet) in the Chure and Mahabharat ranges, this climate is warm in summer but quite cold in winter. The temperature reaches 24 to 31 degrees Celsius in summer, while in winter, it drops to 0 degrees Celsius. The monsoon winds that bring rain come from the

southern region, resulting in about 250 centimeters of rainfall in steep southern areas, while northern slopes receive up to 100 centimeters of rainfall.

(c) Cool Temperate Climate

This type of climate is found in the Mahabharat range at altitudes of 2,100 to 3,350 meters (7,000–11,000 feet). It is warm in summer and quite cold in winter. The temperature during summer ranges from 15 to 20 degrees Celsius, dropping to 0 degrees Celsius in winter. The region receives up to 100 centimeters of precipitation annually, with snowfall in winter. Due to low temperatures and low rainfall, agriculture is very limited here. Although life can be difficult, this climate is considered suitable for health reasons.

(d) Alpine Climate

This type of climate is found in the Himalayan region at altitudes of 3,350 to 5,000 meters (11,000–16,000 feet) above sea level. The temperature during Chaitra, Baisakh, and Jeth can reach up to 10 degrees Celsius, while it remains below 0 degrees Celsius for about nine months of the year. Rainfall is about 30 millimeters here. While agriculture is not practiced, the large alpine pastures are suitable for livestock grazing, making it a good area for animal husbandry and tourism activities.

(e) Polar or Tundra Climate

This extremely cold and dry climate in the Himalayan region is known as pola, or tundra climate. It usually experiences snowfall, and precipitation falls as snow. The temperature in areas above 5,000 meters (16,000 feet) remains below zero.

Forests in Nepal

The geology, climate, and soil of a place influence its vegetation. The climate affects vegetation, indicating an interdependent relationship between the two. Forest resources play a crucial role in the environmental protection and balance of Nepal. According to statistics from 1954, over 45 percent of the country's land area was covered by forest. However, by 1979, it had decreased to 43 percent, 37.4 percent in 1986, and a survey in 1998 indicated that forest cover was only 39.6 percent. A forest survey conducted in 2021 showed that forest cover had increased to 47.56 percent. In the past, significant deforestation occurred for habitation and resettlement, while some areas faced encroachment. Based on the diversity of Nepal's topography and forests, the flora can be classified into the following five groups:

(a) Sub Tropical Evergreen Forest

This forest type is found in the Terai, Bhawar, Dun, and Chure mountains at altitudes of up to 1,200 meters. Due to sufficient heat and rainfall, the trees in this forest are tall, thick, robust, and always green. This forest, which extends parallel from east to west, is also known as "Charkoshe Jhadi" due to its previous extension for four kos. Notable species include Sal, Sissoo, Khayer, and Simul, along with Sabai, Dhaddi, and Ganja. This region is economically and biologically significant due to the presence of wildlife such as elephants, rhinoceroses, tigers, bears, and deer.

(b) Temperate Deciduous Forest

This type of forest is found at altitudes of 1,200 to 2,100 meters in the upper and middle parts of the Chure hills and the lower part of the Mahabharat range. The trees in this forest are tall and thick. The lower part is densely shaded, while the upper part is cooler and experiences frost, resulting in the shedding of many leaves, which is why this forest chain is termed deciduous. In higher elevations, there is a mix of some deciduous and coniferous trees. Prominent species include Sal, Fir, Deodar, Champ, Katuk, Walnut, Gurans, Peepal, Chilaune, Bhorla, Bamboo, Simul, Utes, Palas, Lakuri, and Champ.

(c) Coniferous Forest

This forest is found at altitudes of 2,101 to 3,350 meters in the upper Mahabharat range and lower Himalayas. The cold climate and consistent snowfall throughout the year result in trees and leaves that are pointed like cones. The soil tends to be loamy, resulting in an evergreen forest. Medium-sized softwood species such as Champ, Fir, Deodar, Katuk, Dhuppi, Simul, Chilaune, Betbans, Utes, Bamboo, Gurans, and Bhojpatra are notable here.

(d) Alpine Forest

Found at altitudes of 3,351 to 5,000 meters, alpine vegetation is characterized by low temperatures and low rainfall in the hilly and lower Himalayan regions. Due to the cold and dry climate at this altitude, tall, thick, and hard species of trees cannot thrive. Among the alpine vegetation, lower species such as Gurans, Nigale,

and some shrubs can be found up to an altitude of 3,600 meters, while larger grasslands exist at higher elevations. Colorful flowers and medicinal herbs can be found in the upper areas.

(e) Tundra Forest

Above an altitude of 5,000 meters, where snowfall occurs, vegetation cannot thrive due to the extreme cold. In these areas, only moss and lichen can be found. This type of vegetation, which cannot grow and thrive, is referred to as tundra vegetation or cold desert vegetation.

National Parks of Nepal

No.	National Park	Established (B.S.)	Districts	Area (sq. km)	Main Features
1	Chitwan National Park	2030	Chitwan, Makwanpur, Parsa, Nawalparasi	952.63	One-horned rhinoceros, python, Bengal tiger (Area increased on 2073.7.1)
2	Sagarmatha National Park	2032	Solukhumbu	1148	Musk deer, red panda, Himalayan bear
3	Langtang National Park	2032	Rasuwa, Nuwakot, Sindhupalchok	1710	Leopard, Himalayan tahr, recognized for global biodiversity
4	Rara National Park	2032	Mugu and Jumla	106	Musk deer, red panda, Himalayan bear
5	Bardiya National Park	2032	Bardiya	968	Barasingha, blackbuck
6	Shey Phoksundo National Park	2040	Dolpa and Mugu	3555	Tibetan sheep, Himalayan blue sheep
7	Khaptad National Park	2042	Bajhang, Bajura, Doti, Achham	225	Wild dog, leopard cat, Himalayan black bear
8	Makalu National Park	2048	Sankhuwasabha and Solukhumbu	1500	Snowcock, Himalayan monal, various birds
9	Shivalk National Park	2058	Kathmandu, Nuwakot, Sindhupalchok, Dhading	159	Assamese monkey, yellow-throated marten
10	Banke National Park	2067	Banke, Salyan, Dang	550	Blue bull, Chausigain
11	Shuklaphanta National Park	2031	Kanchanpur	305	Barasingha, one-horned rhinoceros, elephant, bear (Declared a National Park on 2073.11.19)
12	Parsa National Park	2040	Chitwan, Makwanpur, Bara, Parsa	627.39	Sal tree, blue bull, Chausigain, Bengal tiger (Declared a National Park on 2074.2.19)

Conservation Areas

No.	Conservation Area	Established Year	Area (sq. km)	Geographic Location	Notable Wildlife and Declaration Details
1	Annapurna	2049	7629	Lamjung, Manang, Mustang, Myagdi, Kaski	Conservation of rare Himalayan flora and fauna and cultural heritage (Declared on 2049.04.05)
2	Kanchenjunga	2054	2035	Taplejung	Snow leopard, musk deer, Himalayan black bear, wild

					boar, serow, etc. (Declared on 2054.04.06)
3	Manaslu	2055	1663	Gorkha	Snow leopard, musk deer, Himalayan tahr, various birds (Declared on 2055.09.13)
4	Krishna Sar	2065	16.95	Bardiya	Krishna sar, blue bull, python (Declared on 2065.12.03)
5	Gaurishankar	2066	2179	Ramechhap, Dolakha, Sindhupalchok	Snow leopard, musk deer, Himalayan tahr, red panda, Himalayan monal (Declared on 2066.09.27)
6	Api Nampa	2067	1903	Darchula	Snow leopard, musk deer, black bear, yarsagumba (Declared on 2067.03.28)

Minerals in Nepal

The elements, compounds, and substances found in the Earth's crust are considered minerals. Minerals are extremely useful for economic development and prosperity. Many nations rich in minerals have become prosperous examples. If minerals can be excavated and utilized, and if mineral-based industries are established for export, there is a significant possibility of earning foreign currency as well.

Here are some major minerals found in Nepal along with their locations:

Mineral Name	Locations
Iron	Phulchoki, Thoshe, Chitwan, Kulekhani, Bhairahawa, Pyuthan, Bajhang
Copper	Kulekhani, Budhikhola, Myagdi, Dhankuta, Bahrebise, Bandipur, Chisapani
Graphite	Sundarikal, Bhojpur, Lamjung, Bajhang, Gosainkunda
Lead	Phulchoki, Baglung, Rasuwa, Ganesh Himal, Baidi, Tipling
Gold	Kaligandaki, Budhigandaki, Sun Koshi
Limestone	Godawari, Bhairahawa, Chobhar, Hetauda, Palpa, Jogimara
Silver	Baglung, Chisapani Gadhi, Phulchoki
Gas	Terai region, extensive Dailekh, Mustang, Kathmandu Valley
Petroleum	Koilabas in Dang, Nepalgunj, Dhangadhi, Muktinath, Pyuthan, Dailekh
Sulfur	Gosainkunda, Chisapani Gadhi, Barahakshetra
Magnesite	Ganesh Himal, Dolakha, Udayapur
Kharidhung	Sindhupalchok, Khotang, Bhojpur
Slate	Bandipur, Daraun of Syangja, Bagmati, Lumbini, Janakpur
Coal	Chitwan, Dang, Salyan, Chatara, Kathmandu
Gairika (Red Ochre)	Chautara in Sindhupalchok
Cobalt	Dhankuta, Palpa, Gulmi, Arghakhanchi
Marble	Godawari, Mahabharat, Parbat Range
Soda	Doti and Salyan
Rock Salt	Rasuwa, Syaprubeshi
Nickel	Khokaling, Nampa, Bhorle
Salt	Thak Khola in Mustang
Graphite	Sindhupalchok, Palpa

Some major religious sites in Nepal:

Religious Site	Location
Amar Narayan	Palpa
Chhintang Jalpa Devi	Dhankuta
Tapowan Temple	Darchula
Taleju Bhawani Temple	Kathmandu
Pathibhara, Ranikuwa, Sindure Dhunga	Taplejung

Vajrayogini	Lalitpur
Deuti Bajai	Surkhet
Supadeurali/Paanini Tapobhumi	Arghakhanchi
Meen Nath	Patan
Siddhakali Temple	Sankhuwasabha
Halesi Mahadev	Khotang
Chhinnamasta	Saptari
Singhawhini	Taplejung
Dhanpal Gadhi	Morang
Salpa Pokhari	Bhojpur
Baijnath Temple	Achham
Ugratara Temple	DadelDhura
Balatripura Sundari	Dolpa
Chandnath Temple	Jumla
Kailashnath Mahadev	Kavrepalanchok
Swargadhari	Pyuthan
Resunga	Gulmi

Types of Soil Found in Nepal

- Alluvial Soil तलैया माटो
- Sandy Boulder Soil बलौटे माटो
- Red Brown Soil रातो फुस्रो माटो
- Lacustrine Soil पाँगो माटो
- Glacial soil: हिमाली माटो

Demography

Demography is the science that studies the size, description, composition, and changes in population.

